



TRYING TO GET PREGNANT?

When to Have Sex for the Best Chance of Pregnancy

Pregnancy happens when a sperm fertilizes an egg. Because of this, timing sex around ovulation can increase the chance of getting pregnant.

Ovulation is when one of the ovaries releases an egg. This usually happens about 14 days before the next period starts, although the exact day can vary depending on cycle length.

Know Your Fertile Window

A person is most fertile during the days leading up to ovulation and the day of ovulation.

This is because:

- Sperm can live in the reproductive tract for up to 5 days
- An egg survives for about 12 to 24 hours after ovulation

This means the fertile window is about 6 days long.

How to Estimate Ovulation

Ovulation usually happens about 14 days before the next period.

Examples:

- 21-day cycle: around day 7
- 28-day cycle: around day 14
- 35-day cycle: around day 21

The first day of bleeding is counted as day 1.

Signs of Ovulation

One helpful sign is a change in cervical mucus. Around ovulation, it often becomes:

- Clear
- Thin
- Slippery
- Stretchy

Some people also use:

- Period tracking apps
- Ovulation predictor kits
- Basal body temperature tracking

Helpful Fertility Tips

- Have intercourse every day or every other day during the fertile window
- Maintain a healthy body weight
- Avoid smoking
- Limit alcohol
- Review medications with a healthcare provider
- Consider taking a prenatal vitamin with folic acid

When to Talk to a Doctor

- Under 35 and trying for 1 year without pregnancy
- Age 35 to 39 and trying for 6 months
- Age 40 or older and want advice sooner
- Have a known condition that affects fertility

Key Takeaway

The best time to have sex when trying to get pregnant is during the 5 days before ovulation and the day of ovulation. Tracking your cycle and noticing signs like cervical mucus changes can help identify your fertile days.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. Trying to Get Pregnant? Here's When to Have Sex. Mayo Clinic. How to get pregnant.